

**SLOVENIA**

Capital city: Ljubljana
Area: 7,820 sq miles (20,250 sq km)
Population: 1,900,000
Official language: Slovene
Major religions: Christian 98%, other 2%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: Euro
Adult literacy rate: 99%
Life expectancy: 76 years

CROATIA

Capital city: Zagreb
Area: 21,831 sq miles (56,542 sq km)
Population: 4,400,000
Official language: Croatian
Major religions: Christian 92%, Muslim 1%, other 7%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: Kuna
Adult literacy rate: 98%
Life expectancy: 74 years

SLOVENIA

THE SMALL, alpine country of Slovenia lies at the northeastern end of the Adriatic Sea. Formerly ruled by Austria, and later part of Yugoslavia, Slovenia regained its independence in 1991 without getting involved in the ensuing war. It maintains a strategic position in this corner of Europe, and its ports provide Austria with its main maritime outlets. Slovenia joined the EU in 2004.

**ECONOMY**

Widespread forests provide wood for sawmills, furniture, and papermaking industries in Slovenia. In recent years, license agreements with companies in western Europe have allowed local factories to produce a range of cars, trucks, motorcycles, and refrigerators.



RIDING SCHOOLS
 As long ago as 1580, a stud farm was set up in what is now Slovenia to supply horses to the Spanish Riding School in Vienna. The farm eventually bred the famous snow-white Lippizaner horse. Today they are considered the finest riding horses in the world.

SLOVENE PEOPLE

Despite being ruled for almost a thousand years by German-speaking Austrians, the Slovenes have kept their Slav language and folk culture. Colorful embroidery and distinctive headwear, as worn by women at this wedding, are part of that culture. Most people live in small towns or in one of the numerous villages scattered across the country.

Only 300,000 people live in Ljubljana, making it one of Europe's smallest capitals.



Slovene women attend a village wedding.

CROATIA

THE CRESCENT-SHAPED COUNTRY of Croatia was part of Hungary until it was joined to Yugoslavia in 1918. Along with Slovenia, it was the first country to declare its independence in 1991. War erupted almost immediately with Serbia. Until that time, the economy had prospered. Mineral wealth provided the basis for industry while vast areas of fertile land were used for crops. Although the war devastated much of the country, the economy was quick to recover.



The flax plant is harvested when the lower stalk starts to turn yellow.



Linen fiber is obtained by crushing the stalks of the flax plant.

CROATIAN CROPS

The fertile river valleys in the north have a warm climate that is ideal for growing fruits such as plums, apricots, and grapes. Flax is also grown, both for its fiber, which is made into linen clothing and canvas, and for its seeds, which are used for linseed oil.



The islands along the Adriatic coast are popular with tourists.

**TOURISM**

A long coastline with hundreds of islands, bays, and secluded beaches, backed by the dramatic Dinaric Alps, has drawn tourists to Croatia for many years. Much of the damage the historic cities of Zagreb, Dubrovnik, and Split received during the war has been repaired, and tourist levels are returning to what they were before the conflict, with over 50 percent coming from Germany, Italy, and the United Kingdom.

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